

Chapter 1: Combat

Combat in *Iron Kingdoms* is fast-paced and deadly. The following rules govern how characters and their foes interact during battle. All combat is resolved in rounds, each representing approximately six seconds of in-world time.

The Combat Round

Each combat round consists of three phases: **Declaration**, **Resolution**, and **Cleanup**. During Declaration, all participants declare their intended actions simultaneously. The GM resolves actions in order of Initiative, starting with the highest roll. On a tie, the character with the higher Dexterity score acts first.

Initiative

At the start of combat, each participant rolls a d20 and adds their Dexterity modifier. The GM records these values and sorts them from highest to lowest. A character may choose to *Delay*, adjusting their Initiative to act later in the round. Delaying resets their Initiative to the new position for the remainder of the encounter.

Actions on Your Turn

On your turn, you may take one **Standard Action** and one **Move Action**. You may also take any number of **Free Actions** as permitted by the GM. Standard actions include: Attack, Cast a Spell, Use an Item, or Attempt a Skill Check. Move actions include: Walk up to your Speed, Stand Up, or Draw a Weapon.

Attack Rolls and Damage

To make an attack, roll a d20 and add your **Attack Bonus**. If the result equals or exceeds the target's **Armor Class (AC)**, the attack hits. You then roll damage dice appropriate to your weapon and add any relevant modifiers.

Critical Hits

When you roll a natural 20 on an attack roll, you score a **Critical Hit**. Roll all damage dice twice and add your modifiers once. Some weapons have an expanded critical range (e.g., 19–20) that increases the chance of a critical hit.

Cover and Concealment

Targets behind obstacles gain a bonus to AC: **Half Cover** (+2 AC) for low walls or partial barriers, and **Three-Quarters Cover** (+5 AC) for arrow slits or narrow openings. **Full Cover** prevents attacks entirely. Concealment from fog, darkness, or smoke imposes a 20% miss chance on attacks.

Damage Types and Resistance

Damage comes in several types: slashing, piercing, bludgeoning, fire, cold, lightning, acid, poison, necrotic, radiant, psychic, and force. Some creatures have **Resistance** to certain damage types, halving the damage taken. **Immunity** means no damage is taken at all. **Vulnerability** doubles the damage taken.

Example: A red dragon has resistance to fire damage. A fireball that would normally deal 28 damage instead deals only 14 damage to the dragon.

Remember: The GM has final say on all combat rulings. When in doubt, prioritize fun and narrative flow over strict adherence to the rules.